

My Grief Map

Original worksheet by Sophia Cohon, PhD

Use the parts that fit today. You do not have to finish the map or make the loss meaningful.

What I miss What or who feels absent? 	My loss Person, relationship, role, place, future, or part of life 	What changed What is different in daily life?
What I carry Memory, story, ritual, object, prayer, song, place 		What is unfinished Unsaid, complicated, angry, guilty, confusing

What is here today?

☐ Sadness	☐ Anger	☐ Numbness
☐ Relief	☐ Guilt	☐ Yearning
☐ Anxiety	☐ Irritability	☐ Exhaustion
☐ Hard to concentrate	☐ Physical heaviness	☐ Not much right now

When a grief wave hits

☐ Be alone	☐ Be with someone	☐ Move
☐ Cry	☐ Rest	☐ Go outside
☐ Photos	☐ No photos for now	☐ Prayer / ritual
☐ Write	☐ Ordinary routine	☐ Practical help

Who can I be honest with?

What do I need help carrying?

What do I want others to know?

If safety or basic care is becoming difficult, bring that concern to a clinician. This map is a conversation aid, not a safety assessment.

Make room for grief, together

For a clinician or support person

Ask which part of the map the person wants to talk about. Leave space for mixed feelings, silence, and ordinary life.

- Use the person's own words. Do not require a positive meaning or a particular grief stage.
- Offer practical help and company in the form the person wants.
- Ask about changes in daily functioning and safety when concerns arise; use a fuller assessment when needed.

Choose one next step

A time or situation that feels hard

Support I would like then

Something I want to keep close

Something I do not want pushed

What should we watch next?

What gave me a little more room?

What should we check or change next time?

About this worksheet

Original planning tool; not a validated assessment or a reproduced outside worksheet. The sources support the general guidance, not validation of this tool. Guidance checked October 3, 2026.

NHS: [grief after bereavement or loss](#)

[Making Room for Grief | short guide](#)